

THE SCHOLAR

<your quote goes here>

HERO NAME:	LOOK:
PLAYER NAME:	

 **NERVE**

- Dare!
- Shoot!
- Sneak!

 **BRAINS***

- Look Out!
- Investigate!
- Enlighten!

 **CHARM**

- Convince!
- The 3rd Degree!
- Reach Out!

 **TOUGH**

- Fight!
- Defend!
- Push Through!

An Attribute marked with a * is the key attribute for this playbook. Choose a stats allocation and assign attributes accordingly:

- ☐ Generalist: +1, +1, +0, +0
- ☐ Specialist: +2, +1, +0, -1

VIRTUE:
VICE:
CONDITIONS
-0 ☐ In Jeopardy!
-0 ☐
-1 ☐
-2 ☐
EXPERIENCE: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Whenever you roll and get a total of 6 or less, or when a move tells you to, mark an experience box.

SHADOWS OF THE PAST

Narrate a flashback of...

- ☐ A mentor's lesson , and what it taught you
- ☐ Your fondest memory , and how it brings you strength
- ☐ A romantic attachment gone awry , and what you learned from it
- ☐ The first time you saw someone die , and how it shaped you
- ☐ Your darkest hour , and how you overcame it

SHADOWS OF THE UNCANNY

- ☐ Touched by Strangeness - When you Enlighten!, include one strange fact that is not part of real-world history. This is now true.
- ☐ Called down Hidden Paths - When you indulge a Virtue or Vice to clear a Condition, the Hidden World notices. You or the Director introduces a strange sign, supernatural clue, watchful interloper, etc.
- ☐ Scarred by Trackless Wastes - Reduce your Charm by 1 and increase your Brains by 1. Any serious conversation you have eventually bends toward the Unnatural. You may now attempt The Occult Move.
- ☐ Bound to Forbidden Worlds - Take the -0 Condition "Obsessed with the Uncanny" (This overrides any existing -0 Condition). This Condition cannot be cleared.
- ☐ Lost to Darkest Legend - Retire your character from play. Their obsession has overtaken their ordinary life, and they vanish into the Weird as a rumor, warning, relic-hunter, cultist, guardian, or legend.

EQUIPMENT

Choose 1 Ranged Weapon

- ☐ .38 Special (Shoot! Fight!, Lethal, Reload, Concealable)
- ☐ Silenced 9mm (Shoot! Fight!, Lethal, Silent)
- ☐ Hunting Shotgun (+1 Harm, Lethal, Non-Lethal, Shoot!, Reload, Loud, Messy)

Choose 1 Melee Weapon

- ☐ Cane-sword (Fight!, Lethal, Non-Lethal, Concealable)
- ☐ Ceremonial Rapier (+1 Harm, Fight!, Lethal)
- ☐ Dagger (Fight!, Lethal, Silent, Concealable)

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You get four Scholar moves. You get this one:

- ☐ **Call Upon Your Organization** – When you are in good standing with your Organization, and you have the means to contact them, once per Session, roll +Brains.
13+: they provide some useful info or help in the field, and you get an Edge.
10-12: they provide some useful info or help in the field.
7-9: They will give you the help they ask for, but they will give you as task to accomplish as well. If you refuse or fail the task, you will be in trouble with the Organization.
6-: They ask you to do something bad or give what they think you *should* want.

Then pick three of these:

- ☐ **I've Read About This Sort Of Thing** – Roll +Brains instead of +Nerve when you Dare!. The Director may ask you to narrate where you read about it.
- ☐ **I Speak a Little of That** – Chose one culture: European, Asian, African. You are fluent in all Lingua Franca of that culture. Additionally, when you encounter any language outside your fluency in any context (ancient inscription, isolated tribesman, etc), roll +Brains:
13+: You speak the language like a native. You get +1 on all rolls where that language would come into play, such as Convince!, 3rd Degree!, Investigate, etc.
10-12: You are fluent in the language, and get +0 on all related rolls.
7-9: You have some familiarity with the language. You get -1 on all related rolls.
6-: You speak a few words in the language, but will need to find an expert to do more than order coffee or find the bathroom.

- ☐ **The Finer Things** – You can instantly appraise almost any item's value and detect most fakes without rolling. Additionally, you can talk up a mundane item to seem rare and valuable, gaining an Edge usable on Charm rolls where a valuable item would help.

- ☐ **Preparedness** – When you need something unusual or rare, roll +Brains. On a 13+: You have it, and it's perfect. Gain An Edge when using the item.
10+: You have it here right now.
7-9: you have it, but it is flawed or limited in some way. The Director will tell you how.
6-: You know where it is, but it's somewhere real bad.

- ☐ **Academic Network** – Fill in one of the slots in your Contacts List with the name of your academic network, and the following values: Rating: +1, Expertise: Academia, Locale: Everywhere, Relationship: Academic Network. Whenever you need a Contact that specializes in a specific academic subject, you can declare them without rolling. For a move that allows you to upgrade the Contact, you may write that Contact's specific Name and Expertise, and set the Rating to +2.

- ☐ **Expert Researcher** – Any time you would Enlighten! or Investigate! using research (Director's decision), Gain 1 hold from the Investigate! Questions, even on a failure.

The Organization – You are part of an Organization that supports your scholarly activities. Where are they from? How old are they? Are they religious? Are they secret? How do they recruit? Pick the Organizations traditions (these will be used by the Director to determine the Order's methods and actions)

Resources (pick two):

- ☐ Well-armed
- ☐ Well-financed
- ☐ Rigorous training
- ☐ Official pull
- ☐ Cover identities
- ☐ Offices all over the place
- ☐ Good intel
- ☐ Recognised authority
- ☐ Support teams

Red Tape (pick two):

- ☐ Dubious motives
- ☐ Bureaucratic
- ☐ Secretive hierarchy
- ☐ Cryptic missions
- ☐ Hostile superiors
- ☐ Inter-departmental rivalry
- ☐ Budget cuts
- ☐ Take no prisoners policy
- ☐ Acquisitive

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INTRODUCTIONS

When you get here, wait for everyone to catch up so you can do your introductions together. Go around the group. On your turn, introduce your Expert by name and look, and tell the group what they know about you.

HISTORY

Go around the group again. On your turn, pick one of these for each other Hero:

- _____ They are were your student in Academia. Tell them what subject you taught, and they will tell you what they learned
- _____ They came to you for advice, and your advice got them out of trouble. Ask them what the trouble was.
- _____ They know about some of your dark secrets, but they've agreed to keep quiet about them. Tell them what they know.
- _____ A distant relation. Tell them exactly what.
- _____ You were previously both members of an earlier Organization, now disbanded. Ask them why they left, then tell them why you did.
- _____ They once helped you get a singular item that is now part of your collection. Tell them what it was.
- _____ You were taught by the same mentor. Ask them how it ended.
- _____ You saved their life in a tight spot. Tell them what happened.

LEVELING UP

When you have filled all five experience boxes, you level up. Erase the marks and pick an improvement from the following list:

IMPROVEMENTS

- ☐ Get +1 Brains, max +3
- ☐ Get +1 Charm, max +2
- ☐ Get +1 Nerve, max +2
- ☐ Get +1 Tough, max +2
- ☐ Take another Scholar move
- ☐ Take another Scholar move
- ☐ Add a new Resource tag for your Agency
- ☐ Change a Red Tape tag for your Organization
- ☐ Take a move from another playbook
- ☐ Take a move from another playbook

CONTACTS

You may have no more than 5 contacts at any time.

Name	Rating	Expertise	Locale	Relationship